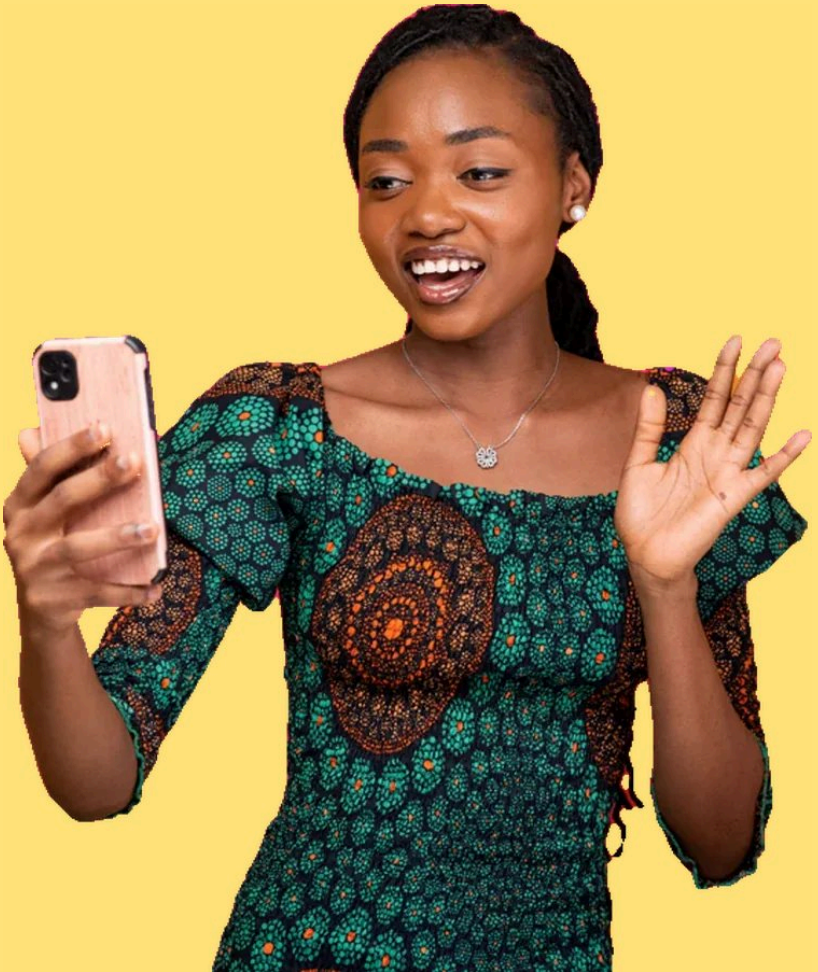
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FREE TEMPLATES · 2026 EDITION

Abandoned Cart Message Templates: Email and WhatsApp

So your store is live, and you want to win back customers who added items to their cart and left without paying. Good! But now you're looking at an empty message box thinking, "What do...



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So your store is live, and you want to win back customers who added items to their cart and left without paying. Good! But now you're looking at an empty message box thinking, "What do I actually write?" Don't worry, we've got you.

The good news? You don't need to be a great writer. This starter pack gives you simple templates you can change and use right away to bring customers back and recover sales you would have lost.

01 Why a Series of Messages Works Better Than One

Many sellers find that two or three reminders bring back more buyers than a single one. Each message has a different job and reaches the customer at a different point in their decision.

Think of it like this: the first message is a gentle reminder, the second builds trust, and the third gives them a reason to act now.

Many Nigerian customers check WhatsApp more often than email. If the customer gave you their number and agreed to hear from you, send a short WhatsApp version too. We include one under each template.

02 Template #1: The Friendly Reminder (Send 1 Hour After They Leave)

Subject line options:

- "Did you forget something?"
- "You left something in your cart"
- "Still interested? Your cart is waiting"

Email body:

Hi [First Name],

We noticed you left some items in your cart. No wahala, we saved everything for you!

[Product Image] [Product Name] [Price, e.g. ₦18,500]

[Big "Complete Your Order" Button]

Need help? Just reply to this email or message us on WhatsApp.

Best, [Your Store Name]

WhatsApp version:

"Hi [First Name], this is [Your Store Name]. You left the [Product Name] (₦18,500) in your cart. We've saved it for you: [link]. Any questions? Just reply here."

Why this works: It is short, friendly and not pushy. The product picture reminds them why they wanted it.

03 Template #2: The Trust Builder (Send 24 Hours Later)

Subject line options:

- "Still thinking about it?"
- "Here's why customers love [Product Name]"
- "Your cart is waiting (and here's why it's worth it)"

Email body:

Hi [First Name],

You haven't finished your order yet. We understand. When you buy online, you want to be sure.

Here's what makes [Product Name] special: ✓ [Key Benefit #1] ✓ [Key Benefit #2] ✓ [Key Benefit #3]

Don't just take our word for it: "[Short customer review]" – [Customer Name, e.g. Bisi from Ibadan]

[Product Image]

[Big "Complete Your Order" Button]

Questions? Our team is ready to help!

Best, [Your Store Name]

P.S. Pay by card, bank transfer or USSD, or pay on delivery in Lagos. Not happy? Return it within 7 days.

WhatsApp version:

"Hi [First Name], still thinking about the [Product Name]? [Customer Name] said: '[Short review]'. You can pay on delivery in Lagos. Should I hold it for you?"

Why this works: It answers doubt by showing value. Real reviews and clear payment and return options make buyers feel safe, which matters to shoppers who worry about online scams.

04 Template #3: The Final Nudge (Send 48–72 Hours Later)

Subject line options:

- "Last chance: your cart expires soon"
- "We've taken 10% off your cart"

- “Don’t miss out on [Product Name]”

Email body:

Hi [First Name],

This is your last reminder! We’ve been holding your cart, but we can only keep it for so long.

[Product Image] [Product Name] ~~₦18,500~~ ₦16,650

To make your decision easier, here’s 10% off. Just use the code COMEBACK10 when you pay.

[Big “Claim Your Discount” Button]

This offer ends in 24 hours, so grab it while you can!

Best, [Your Store Name]

WhatsApp version:

“Hi [First Name], last one from us! Use COMEBACK10 for 10% off the [Product Name]: ₦16,650 instead of ₦18,500. Ends in 24 hours: [link]”

Why this works: It gives a reason to act now, with a small reward. The deadline is a gentle push without being aggressive.

05 Tips to Make the Templates Your Own

These templates are starting points, not strict rules:

Match your brand voice: Selling luxury perfume oils or gold jewellery? Keep it elegant. Selling sneakers or phone accessories? Keep it casual and fun.

Add the details customers worry about: Include delivery areas and times (for example, “1–2 days in Lagos with GIG Logistics or Kwik, 3–5 days to Abuja, Port Harcourt and Kano”), your return policy, and how they can pay (Paystack, Flutterwave, bank transfer, pay on delivery). These worries are often why people leave.

Test different approaches: Try different subject lines, send times and discounts. Watch how many people open your messages and how many go on to pay.

Make it work on phones: Most customers read on Android phones. Keep words short and buttons big enough to tap.

Respect your customers: Only message people who agreed to hear from you, and stop after three reminders.

06 When to Skip the Discount

You don't always need a discount in your third message. If you sell expensive or one-of-a-kind items, like hand-made adire or Aba leather bags, show that stock is low instead: "Only 2 left" or "This colour is selling fast." Save discounts for busy markets where price matters more, like phone accessories or hair.

07 Quick Setup Checklist

Ready to use these templates? Here's your action plan:

- Choose your tool: Mailchimp or Brevo for email, WhatsApp Business, or your store's built-in reminders (Shopinbos sends cart reminders, and Peggy, the AI assistant, can follow up in WhatsApp chats)
- Copy the templates and match them to your brand voice
- Set the timing (1 hour, 24 hours, 48–72 hours)
- Add product pictures, naira prices and store details
- Test by leaving a cart in your own store
- Check how many carts you recover and adjust

08 Start Recovering Sales Today

With these templates, you're ready to turn forgotten carts into paid orders. The perfect reminder message doesn't exist. What matters is getting started, learning from your results and improving over time.

Copy these templates, make them your own, and watch those carts turn into orders. Every message is another chance to save a sale that would have disappeared. Now go and get those sales back!

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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